

PORTFOLIO — 2026

Maylla Souza

Product Design Consultant

10+ years designing for fintech, Banking-as-a-Service, and multi-brand White Label platforms. Currently leading design system governance and hi-fi product design at a stealth startup, with AI-augmented workflows for scalable execution.

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ABOUT

Designing for complexity, at scale.

I design digital products with a strict focus on business strategy, agile delivery, and data-driven decisions. Over more than a decade, I've specialized in solving complex architecture and interface problems across fintech, Banking-as-a-Service, multi-brand White Label ecosystems, and enterprise SaaS.

My approach pairs a solid foundation in process and project management — backed by an MBA from FGV — with hands-on team leadership and global design system governance. I use an agile mindset to align complex stakeholders and keep delivery efficient, today augmented by AI-powered design workflows.

01 · STRATEGY

Design backlog management & DesignOps
Stakeholder alignment & C-level communication
Technical mentorship & career development
Agile mindset, data-driven decisions

02 · PRODUCT

Multi-brand & White Label architecture
Design system governance & componentization
Interaction architecture for complex flows
Research, journey mapping, usability testing

03 · TECHNOLOGY

AI-augmented design workflows
Semantic tokens, engineering handoff
Tailwind CSS integration
Fintech, BaaS, treasury, low-code

SELECTED WORK

Five case studies, chosen for the range of problems they solve — from a single interaction down to a platform-wide system.

Arc Design System

A multi-tenant fintech design system, built from zero — brand identity, components, and product flows, together.

● CHALLENGE ● PROCESS ● DECISIONS ● OUTCOME

CHALLENGE

Arc launched with no visual identity, no component library, and no established design language. The product itself was still being defined — PRDs arrived in iterations, and every foundational choice had to hold up across a scope that kept expanding, as the sole designer responsible for brand, system, and product at once.

PROCESS

I architected the system for multi-tenant deployment from day one — separating the token layer from component logic, and organizing everything into Global, Player-facing, and Admin layers, each independently skinnable.

KEY DECISIONS

- 01 Token-based theming, not duplication** — a new operator rebrands through a token swap, never a component rebuild.
- 02 Claude as a technical execution partner**, used directly through the Figma MCP connector for component architecture decisions and plugin-driven design system work — not just early ideation.
- 03 Evolution treated as part of the system**, not a failure of v1 — three refactor passes before calling the foundation stable.

97

Published components — Global, Player & Admin

288

Component swaps in one evolution sprint

10+

Product pages with full PRD coverage

Figma → Storybook

Chromatic visual regression pipeline

OUTCOME

What started as a brand kit became a governed, multi-tenant design system — proof that early architecture decisions can still flex months later without breaking.

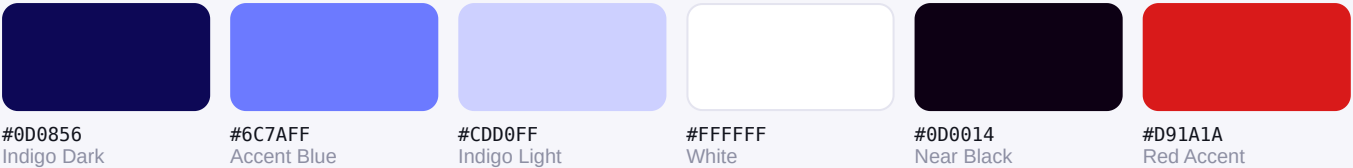
Design Systems

AI-Augmented Workflow

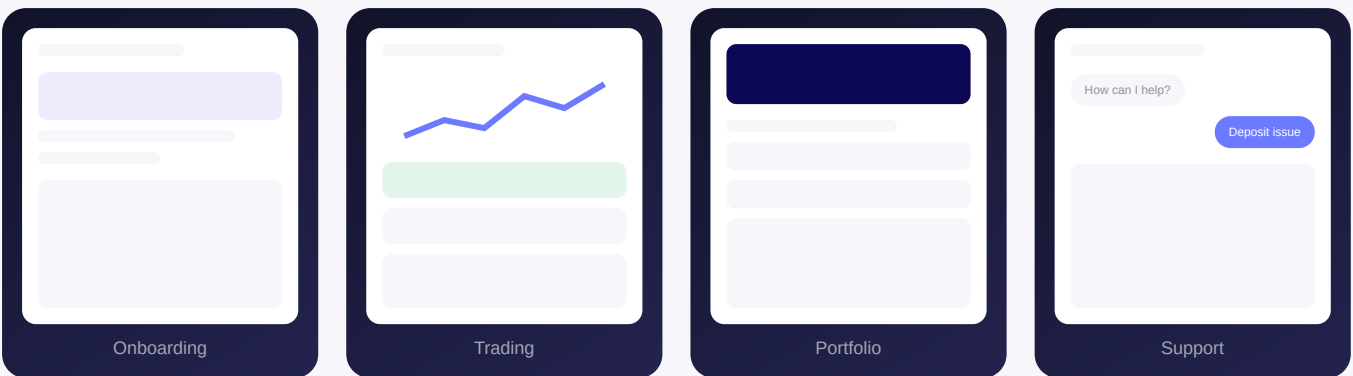
Brand identity, in service of a system.

Visual language built for clarity, confidence, and multi-context application.

COLOR TOKENS

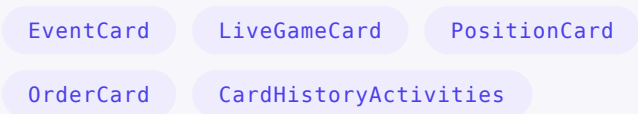


SELECTED SCREENS — ONBOARDING · TRADING · PORTFOLIO · SUPPORT



COMPONENT SHOWCASE

30+ components across 7 categories, built for a scalable, multi-layer system.



BUILT WITH

Figma — component architecture & tokens

Storybook — documentation & dev handoff

ClickUp — DS backlog & gap tracking

Claude — AI design partner via Figma MCP

Currency Selector in Cashflow

Multi-currency treasury management, designed so finance directors never lose track of where a number came from.

● CHALLENGE ● PROCESS ● DECISIONS ● OUTCOME

CHALLENGE

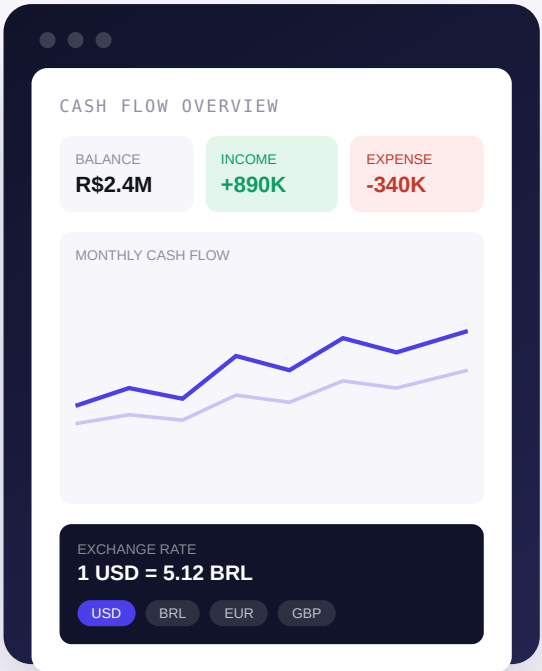
Accountfy's cashflow module handled multiple currencies, but the existing interface buried conversion context behind manual lookups. Finance directors managing international operations needed to compare values across currencies without losing track of the underlying exchange rate or which figures were already converted.

PROCESS

I mapped how finance teams actually scan a cashflow view — from totals to line items and back — and tested currency-switching patterns that kept that scanning order intact instead of forcing a full reload or a modal interruption.

KEY DECISIONS

- 01 Inline switching, not replacement** — the original entry stays visible next to the converted value, so the source of a number is never ambiguous.
- 02 A persistent rate indicator**, not a tooltip — the exchange rate is decision-relevant information, not a footnote.
- 03 View-scoped currency**, not account-scoped — comparing two markets never requires leaving the screen.



OUTCOME

A cashflow view finance directors can trust at a glance — every number carries its own currency context, and switching markets feels like changing a filter.

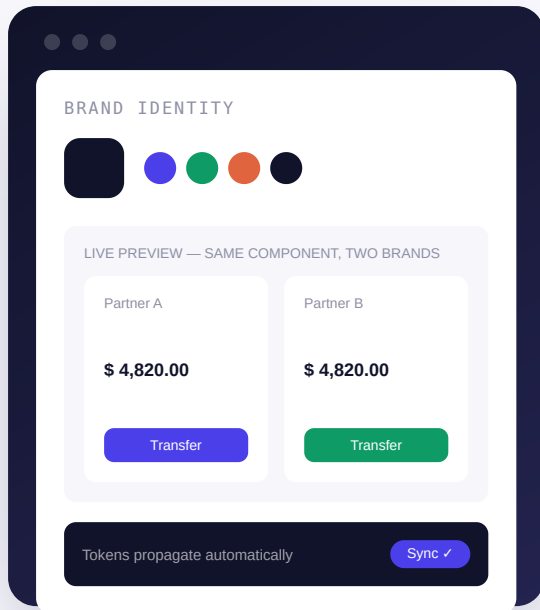
Fintech Treasury

Interaction Design

White Label BaaS Platform

Banking infrastructure that partner brands can make their own, without touching a line of code.

● CHALLENGE — ● PROCESS — ● DECISIONS — ● OUTCOME



OUTCOME

New partner brands onboard by reconfiguring tokens, not rebuilding screens — the design system became what scaled, not the bottleneck.

BaaS

White Label

Design Systems

CHALLENGE

Own's BaaS platform served multiple partner companies, each needing its own visual identity layered over the same underlying banking infrastructure. Too much freedom and the experience fragments into inconsistent, hard-to-maintain interfaces; too little and the platform stops feeling like the partner's own product.

PROCESS

I led the move from hard-coded styles to a token-based architecture — separating what a component does from how it looks, so brand identity became a configuration, not a redesign.

KEY DECISIONS

- 01 Semantic tokens between primitives and components** — a partner's color, type, and spacing choices propagate everywhere automatically.
- 02 A constrained customization surface** — logo, palette, typography, a few layout variants — kept ownership without opening the door to usability regressions.
- 03 Documentation lived next to components** in Storybook, so engineering could ship new brands without designer involvement for routine cases.

NEXT CASE

BALANCE UNIFICATION APP →

Balance Unification App

One coherent financial picture, built from accounts that were never meant to talk to each other.

- CHALLENGE
- PROCESS
- DECISIONS
- OUTCOME

CHALLENGE

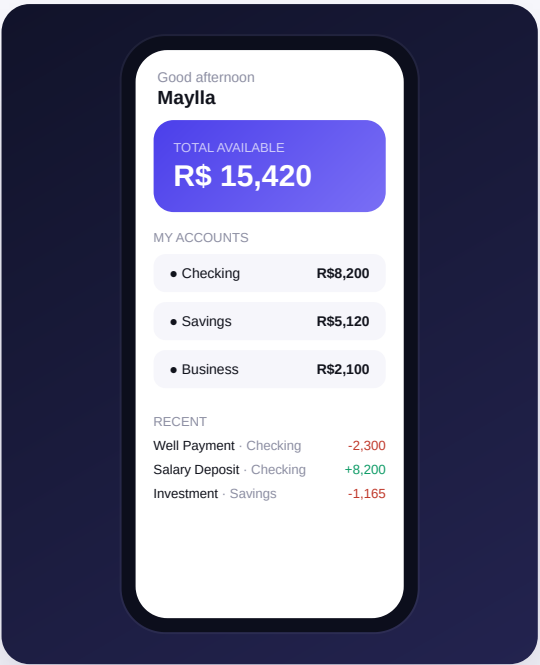
Users held several financial products under the same umbrella — checking, savings, business accounts — but each lived in its own silo, with its own balance and its own transaction history. The mobile experience needed to unify them without pretending the underlying complexity wasn't there.

PROCESS

I worked from real transaction data to design a hierarchy that prioritized the number people actually wanted first — total available balance — while keeping each account's identity legible underneath it.

KEY DECISIONS

- 01 **One unified balance up top**, with individual accounts always one tap away — never hidden behind a menu.
- 02 **Transactions tagged by account of origin**, not merged into an undifferentiated feed, so users could still reason about where money moved.
- 03 **Visual weight reserved for amounts and names** — icons and metadata recede so the numbers read first.



OUTCOME

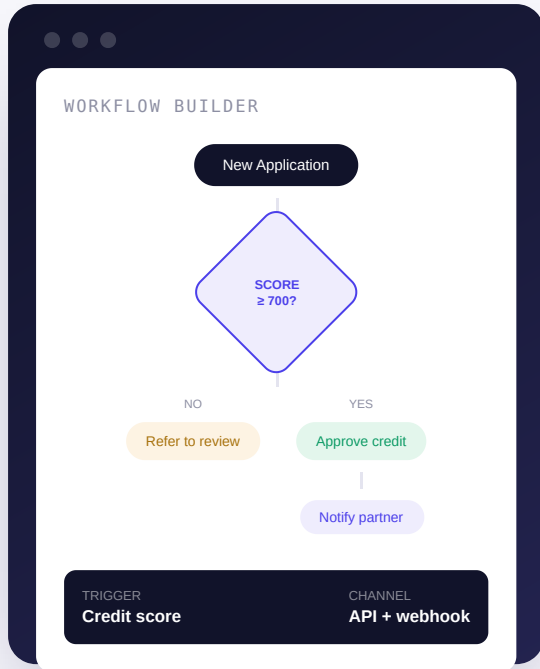
The unified view became the default entry point to the app, replacing what had been a confusing account-switcher as the very first thing users saw.

- Mobile UX
- BaaS
- IA

Cora Workflow Automation

A low-code decision engine that let non-technical teams build the automations engineers used to own. Adopted by Nextel and Santander.

● CHALLENGE — ● PROCESS — ● DECISIONS — ● OUTCOME



OUTCOME

Business teams at both institutions could ship and adjust their own automation rules directly, cutting engineering out of the loop for routine changes.

Low-code

Automation

SaaS

CHALLENGE

Nextel and Santander needed to configure complex business rules and campaign logic without filing a ticket with engineering every time a rule changed. The interface had to make conditional logic — branches, thresholds, exceptions — legible to people who had never written a line of code.

PROCESS

I treated the canvas itself as the documentation: instead of abstract form fields, the workflow builder represented logic as a visual graph that mirrored how business users already described their own rules out loud.

KEY DECISIONS

- 01 Plain-language conditions**, not technical operators — lowering the barrier for non-technical configuration.
- 02 Inline validation while building**, catching contradictory branches before publish instead of failing silently in production.
- 03 A canvas built for density** — scaling from a five-step rule to a sprawling decision tree without losing legibility, since dense flows were the norm for these clients.

MORE WORK

ADDITIONAL PROJECTS →

Earlier and lighter-weight projects.

Smaller in scope, but part of how the practice above was built.

República.org — UX Analysis

2022

Comprehensive UX audit identifying usability issues and proposing improvements to navigation, information architecture, and content hierarchy for a nonprofit-sector platform.

UX Audit

Web

Usability

Blue Origen — Hypothesis Board

2021

Lean UX exploration mapping hypotheses — validated and invalidated — to align early product bets with real user needs before any code was written.

Lean UX

Research

Product Design

Sysmarketing — Registration Flow

2020

Progressive-disclosure onboarding flow that broke a dense signup form into manageable steps, reducing the chance of drop-off at first contact.

UI/UX

Forms

Onboarding

CRM White Label

ZUP INNOVATION — 2017

Adaptable CRM interface serving financial and telecom clients, each with its own brand skin layered over a shared underlying system.

CRM

White Label

Telecom

CRM Cliente Bancário

ZUP INNOVATION — 2017

Banking-focused CRM built for support teams, integrating service history and account metrics into a single customer timeline.

CRM

Banking

Customer Service

SKILLS & EXPERTISE

The toolkit behind the work.

DESIGN TOOLS

Figma, Sketch, Adobe XD, Storybook, Miro, FigJam

UX METHODS

User research, usability testing, journey mapping, interaction flows, wireframing, prototyping, design sprints, workshops

DESIGN SYSTEMS

Multi-brand / White Label systems, component libraries, design tokens, semantic token architecture, Tailwind CSS integration

TECHNICAL

HTML/CSS, React basics, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Git, API literacy, Figma API scripting

AI INTEGRATION

Anthropic Claude, AI-assisted design workflows, PRD crosschecks, component architecture decisions with AI as a technical execution partner

DOMAINS

Fintech, BaaS, White Label, treasury, payments, credit portals, digital banking, telecom, SaaS

LEADERSHIP

DesignOps, team mentoring, career development, stakeholder management, cross-functional collaboration

Mockups throughout this portfolio are conceptual recreations built to respect NDAs in place with former employers. Full visual case files are available on request.

LET'S TALK

Let's design the next generation of digital products together.

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